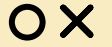


BY VISHAL LAKSHMI NARAYANAN



CULTURE BITES



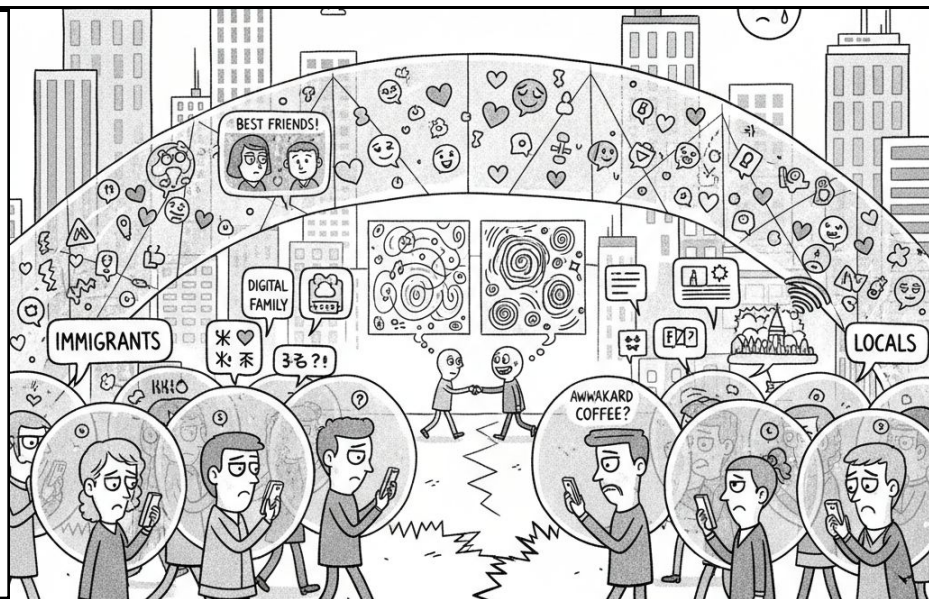
SODA PROJECT PITCH



PROBLEM

People feel more “connected” digitally but lonelier in real life. Immigrants and locals rarely interact beyond surface-level spaces.

Food, our most natural way to connect, has become impersonal. There’s no space where people can meet, share, and belong again.



Culture Bites is a cultural exchange platform that uses food as the vehicle for community engagement.

Users can sign up for intimate **group dining experiences**, bonding with new friends over **home cooked meals**.



VISION & OBJECTIVE



- Culture Bites envisions a world where technology doesn't just connect screens, but connects people again face to face, through food.
- Our goal is to turn every shared meal into a micro-community powered by transparent systems, local empowerment, and scalable tech infrastructure.
- The platform isn't just about dining; it's about engineering empathy at scale.

THE ECOSYSTEM

GUESTS

Discover authentic food events near them. Join shared tables, experience cultures firsthand, and leave with more than a meal, a story.



HOSTS

Open their homes or spaces for gatherings.
Create a safe, welcoming environment where stories, flavors, and friendships grow.

COOKS

Share their culture through home-cooked dishes.
Turn recipes into stories that build empathy and celebrate identity.



Guests Gain Good Food



- Guests book and attend dining events near them
- Filter by cuisine, date, price, dietary preferences
- Guests pay a fee that includes a service fee and portion of the ingredient cost

**Guests gain good food,
and exposure to new
people and experiences!**



Hosts Turn Homes Into Hubs



- Hosts offer their space to cooks for events
- Builds trust, hospitality, and community identity through shared spaces
- Churches, community centers, clubhouses can get more use out of their space
- Hosts receive a 25% commission per guest

**Not everyone can cook,
but they can still
participate and benefit**



Cooks share Culture



- Anyone with cooking skills can share their authentic cultural knowledge
- Set menus, prices, and schedule events
- Partner with hosts or use their own space
- Cooks receive a 60% commission per guest

Gives underrepresented communities a way to make a living off their lived experiences!





Features and Functionalities

Event Management System

Comprehensive event lifecycle management:

Event Properties:

- Title, cuisine type, description
- Date, start/end time, location
- Seat capacity and availability
- Host and Cook assignments
- Rich media (multiple images)

Guest Interaction:

- Seat request submission
- Dietary restrictions/notes
- Request status: Pending → Approved/Waitlist/Declined
- Real-time availability updates

Collaboration Request System

Two-way marketplace enabling Cooks and Hosts to partner:

Request Type | Flow | Status Tracking

Cook → Host | Cook proposes dishes for Host's space |
Pending → Accepted/Declined
Host → Cook | Host invites Cook for specific event |
Pending → Accepted/Declined

Features:

- Proposed dish lists
- Custom messages
- Request history tracking
- Real-time status updates

Multi-Step Profile Wizards

Guided profile creation with validation:

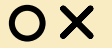
Host Profile Wizard:

1. Space title and description
2. Location and capacity
3. Venue photos (upload or Pexels search)
4. Review and submit

Cook Profile Wizard:

1. Name and origin country
2. Specialties and cuisine types
3. Personal story
4. Cuisine images
5. Review and submit

Hosts page setting up an event



The screenshot shows the CultureBites website interface for hosts. The background is dimmed, showing sections like 'Active Host Profile', 'My Space' (Dining Hall), and 'My Events'. A modal titled 'Create Event - Step 1 of 3' is open in the center. The modal contains the following fields and controls:

- Event Title:** A text input field with placeholder text 'e.g., Authentic Oaxacan Feast'.
- Cuisine Type:** A dropdown menu with the text 'Select cuisine'.
- Date:** A text input field with placeholder 'mm/dd/yyyy' and a calendar icon.
- Total Seats:** A text input field with the value '20'.
- Start Time:** A time selection field with a clock icon.
- End Time:** A time selection field with a clock icon.
- Location:** A text input field with placeholder 'e.g., San Francisco, CA'.
- Navigation:** 'Back' and 'Next' buttons at the bottom.

In the background, the 'My Events' section shows an upcoming event: 'Ratatouille' on 11/20/2025 from 12:15 to 1:15, with 4/4 seats available and a 'French' cuisine tag.

Cook profile set up page



CultureBites

Meet, Greet, Eat, Repeat

Active Cook Profile

+ New Profile



My Cook Profile



Wen Foo

📍 Japan

SPECIALTIES

Sushis

Ramen

MY STORY

My name is Wen Foo, and sushi has been part of my life since I was old enough to hold a knife. I grew up in Kyoto, where my father ran a tiny sushi stall tucked between a temple and a tea house. He used to tell me, "Sushi is not just food — it's a conversation between the fish, the rice, and your heart." When I moved abroad, I missed that harmony — the sound of the knife, the scent of fresh rice vinegar, the calm silence before the first customer arrives. So I began making sushi again, one roll at a time, in my small kitchen. Now, every piece I serve carries that memory — of precision, patience, and peace. I cook to share that quiet joy with others. Because for me, sushi isn't just a meal; it's a moment of balance that reminds me where I come from.

MY DISHES



My Connections

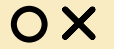
Accepted 1

Danny

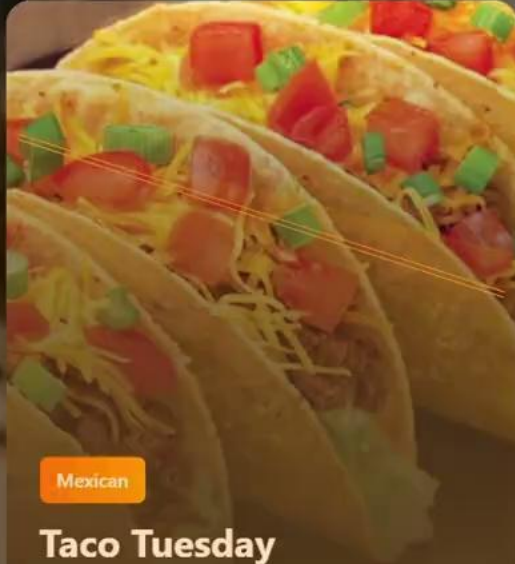
An Office Space

Event: Sushi Saturday

Guest page for events



5 Events Available



Mexican

Taco Tuesday

Click to reveal details



Indian

Chaat Corner

Click to reveal details



Japanese

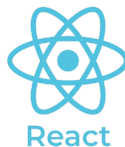
Sushi Saturday

Click to reveal details

Tech Stack Used



Next Js framework for
entire website flow



React for rendering
components



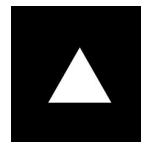
Supabase to manage all
databases



Tailwind css for UI
designs



Git for codebase
management



Vercel for deployment



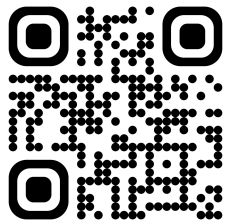
Future Implementations

- Payment Integration: Stripe for event ticketing and Cook/Host payouts
- Messaging System: In-app chat between Guests, Hosts, and Cooks
- Review & Ratings: Post-event feedback and reputation system
- Calendar Sync: iCal/Google Calendar integration
- Social Sharing: Share events on social media

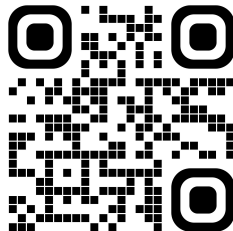


Check out my Project!

Github Repo



Website



**THANKS TO MY MENTOR
SACHIN VENUGOPAL
NAIR FOR GUIDING ME
THROUGHOUT THE
PROJECT AND SODA FOR
THIS AMAZING
OPPORTUNITY**